

stantly updating the curriculum to prepare students for Gen AI by embedding it into all courses,” says Mita Brahma, National HR Head at NIIT Ltd.

But all this requires funds. “IIMs are no longer supported by the government. We fund our operations primarily through student fees and, to some extent, executive education,” says Kunal Ganguly, Dean of Development at IIM Kashipur. There’s also pressure to generate revenue from executive education. But increasing fees is a challenge as B-schools already charge high amounts.

Enter certificate courses—from digital marketing to data analytics—marketed by edtechs. According to estimates, there are currently about 600 such courses being offered by IIMs and other premier institutes across India. However, Jain of S.P. Jain feels edtechs dilute the brand image of B-schools. “They are useful only for increasing revenue at the low end, but they detract from the prestige of a degree-awarding institution,” he says.

STUDENTS’ SURVIVAL GUIDE

B-schools also need to accept students’ media consumption habits. They no longer prefer reading as much as they prefer watching videos or listening to podcasts. Platforms like Coursera and edX, that have the largest MOOCs (massive open online courses) globally, offer high-quality video content that aligns with this generation’s media preferences. “Partnerships with MOOCs will go a long way in democratising education, espe-

THE PLACEMENT CHALLENGE



FALLING AVERAGE SALARIES AND PLACEMENTS SHOW A DISCONNECT BETWEEN TRADITIONAL EDUCATION AND INDUSTRY NEEDS



INDUSTRY 4.0 DEMANDS SKILLS IN DATA ANALYTICS, AI, AND CLOUD COMPUTING, MAKING TECHNICAL EXPERTISE MORE VALUABLE



START-UP ENTREPRENEURSHIP CULTURE IS DRAWING THE BEST MBA TALENT AWAY FROM THE JOB MARKET



INDUSTRY IS CAUTIOUS ABOUT HIRING DUE TO DEMAND UNCERTAINTY AND RAPIDLY CHANGING BUSINESS STRATEGIES



RISE IN MBA PROGRAMMES HAS LED TO TOO MANY GRADUATES ENTERING THE JOB MARKET, POTENTIALLY SHOWING LOW INDUSTRY OFFTAKE

cially for B-schools that struggle to attract top faculty. Even lower-tier B-schools that cannot hire high-quality professors can benefit from these collaborations,” says Das of IMI.

At IIM Kashipur, the institute has reduced the duration of a class from 90 minutes to 75 minutes, “because we realised that 90 minutes is too long to hold a student’s attention,” says Ganguly.

“To place the entire responsibility on academic institutions to produce brilliant professionals is also not correct. It’s just that the industry’s requirements are changing much quicker and faster than academia can adapt,” says K.S. Viswanathan, Strategic Advisor at Peoplefy.

Students, too, must realise that pursuing an MBA is not a passport to a cushy job. “It is imperative for students to stay abreast of the latest trends and acquire relevant skills to enhance their employability,” says Arora of Biz Staffing Comrade. This could mean pursuing additional certifications, engaging in continuous learning, or gaining practical experience through internships in innovative sectors.

Finally, the dominance of engineers in B-schools is likely to return, with the growing demand for technical and analytical expertise. “A business school is at best the beginning of a transformation journey. It is important to recognise that you are here to start that journey, and when you leave, the transformational journey must continue,” says Ramachandran of K J Somaiya. Are you ready? **BT**

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